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CSE 2201 : Algorithms

Lecture 12: Greedy Problems – Bin Packing

Atanu Shuvam Roy



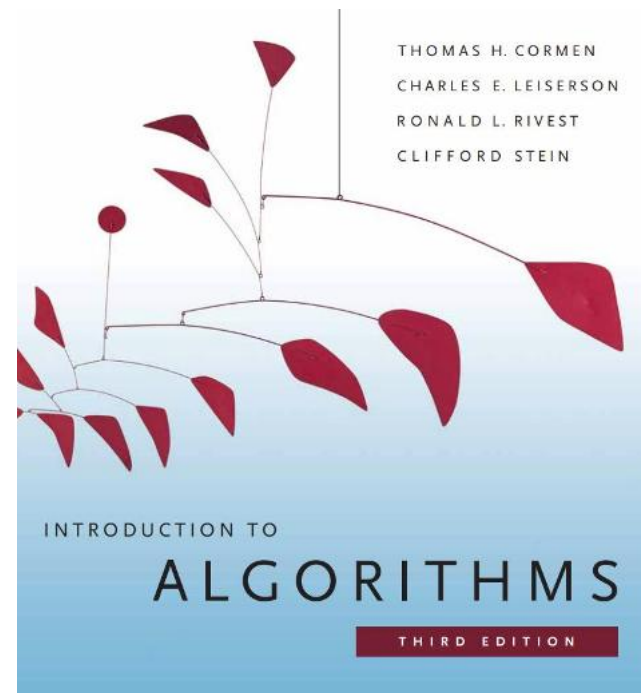
Class Code
GVWTHYJV



Fall 2025

Reference Book

- Introduction to Algorithms, 3rd edition. T.H. Cormen, C.E. Leiserson, R.L. Rivest, C. Stein



Distribution of Marks

Assessments	%
Mid Term Examination	25
Final Examination	40
Attendance & class performance	10
Assignment & Quizzes	25
Total	100

Today's Contents

- **Knapsack Problem**
- **Huffman Coding**

Greedy Algorithms

Part - 3 : Knapsack Problem



Knapsack Problem

1. 0/1 Knapsack

- Either take all of an item or none.

2. Fractional Knapsack

- You can take fractional amount of an item.

Concept of Knapsack Problem

A Set of Items are given where,

- No of Items = $n = [X_1, X_2, X_3, \dots, X_n]$
- Weight of $X_i = W_i$
- Profit of $X_i = P_i$
- Knapsack Size = m

Goal:

- Maximize the Profit $\sum P_i X_i$ within $\sum W_i X_i \leq m$

Fractional Knapsack



10 oz., \$1,000



Max Weight: 400 oz.



100 oz., \$2,000



300 oz., \$4,000



1 oz., \$5,000



200 oz., \$5,000



Fractional Knapsack problem

ITEM	PRICE	WEIGHT
X1	25	18
X2	24	15
X3	15	10

Total Item , $n = 3$

Knapsack Size , $m = 20$

Three Cases:

1. Maximum Price
2. Minimum Weight
3. Maximum P_i/W_i

X1	X2	X3	$\Sigma W_i X_i$	$\Sigma P_i X_i$

Fractional Knapsack problem

ITEM	PRICE	WEIGHT
X1	25	18
X2	24	15
X3	15	10

Total Item , $n = 3$

Knapsack Size , $m = 20$

Three Cases:

1. Maximum Price
2. Minimum Weight
3. Maximum P_i/W_i

X1	X2	X3	$\Sigma W_i X_i$	$\Sigma P_i X_i$

Case – 1:

Item 1 : X1 (1)
Profit = 25
 $m = 20 - 18 = 2$

Item 2 : X2 (2/15)
Profit = $24 * (2/15)$
= 3.2
 $m = 2 - 2 = 0$

Total Profit
= $25 + 3.2$
= **28.2**

Fractional Knapsack problem

ITEM	PRICE	WEIGHT
X1	25	18
X2	24	15
X3	15	10

Total Item , $n = 3$

Knapsack Size , $m = 20$

Three Cases:

1. Maximum Price
2. Minimum Weight
3. Maximum P_i/W_i

X1	X2	X3	$\Sigma W_i X_i$	$\Sigma P_i X_i$
1	2/15	0	20	28.2

Case – 2:

Item 1 : X3 (1)
Profit = 15
 $m = 20 - 10 = 10$

Item 2 : X2 (10/15)
Profit = $24 * (2/3)$
= 16
 $m = 10 - 10 = 0$

Total Profit
= 15 + 16
= 31

Fractional Knapsack problem

ITEM	PRICE	WEIGHT
X1	25	18
X2	24	15
X3	15	10

Total Item , $n = 3$

Knapsack Size , $m = 20$

Three Cases:

1. Maximum Price
2. Minimum Weight
3. Maximum P_i/W_i

X1	X2	X3	$\Sigma W_i X_i$	$\Sigma P_i X_i$
1	2/15	0	20	28.2
0	10/15	1	20	31

Case – 3: (P_i / W_i)

$$\begin{aligned} X1 &= P1/W1 \\ &= 25/18 = 1.39 \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} X2 &= P2/W2 \\ &= 24/15 = 1.6 \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} X3 &= P3 / W3 \\ &= 15 / 10 = 1.5 \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Item 1 : } X2 &(1) \\ \text{Profit} &= 24 \\ m &= 20 - 15 = 5 \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Item 2 : } X3 &(5/10) \\ \text{Profit} &= 15 * (1/2) \\ &= 7.5 \\ m &= 10 - 10 = 0 \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Total Profit} & \\ &= 24 + 7.5 \\ &= 31.5 \end{aligned}$$

Fractional Knapsack problem

ITEM	PRICE	WEIGHT
X1	25	18
X2	24	15
X3	15	10

Total Item , $n = 3$

Knapsack Size , $m = 20$

Three Cases:

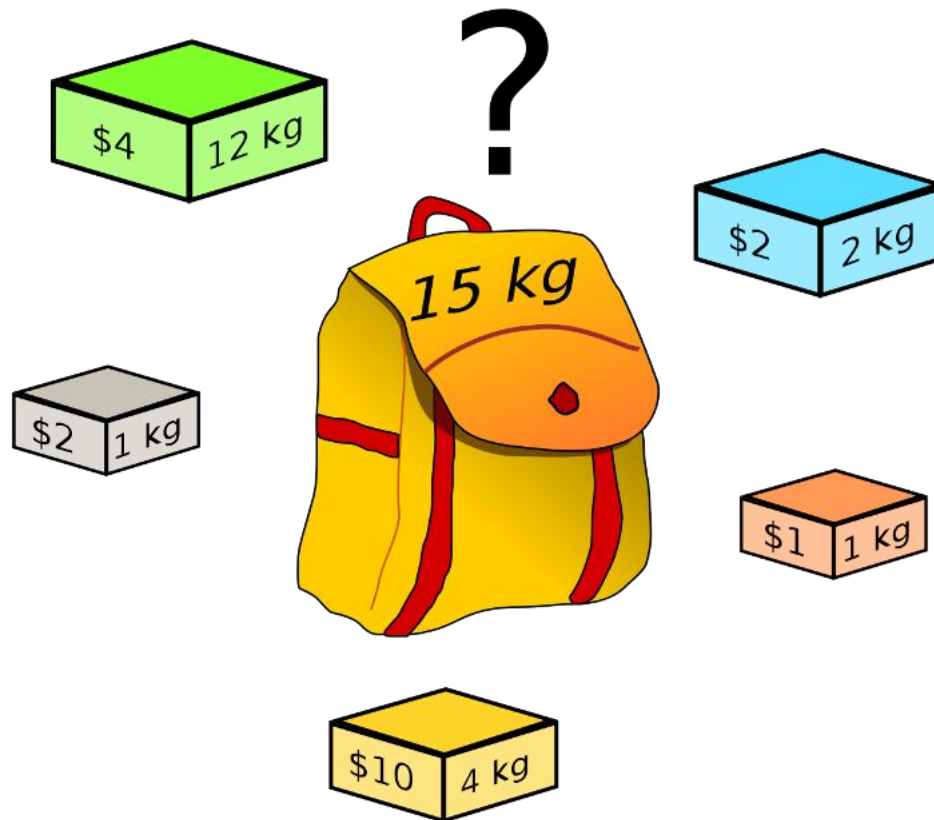
1. Maximum Price

2. Minimum Weight

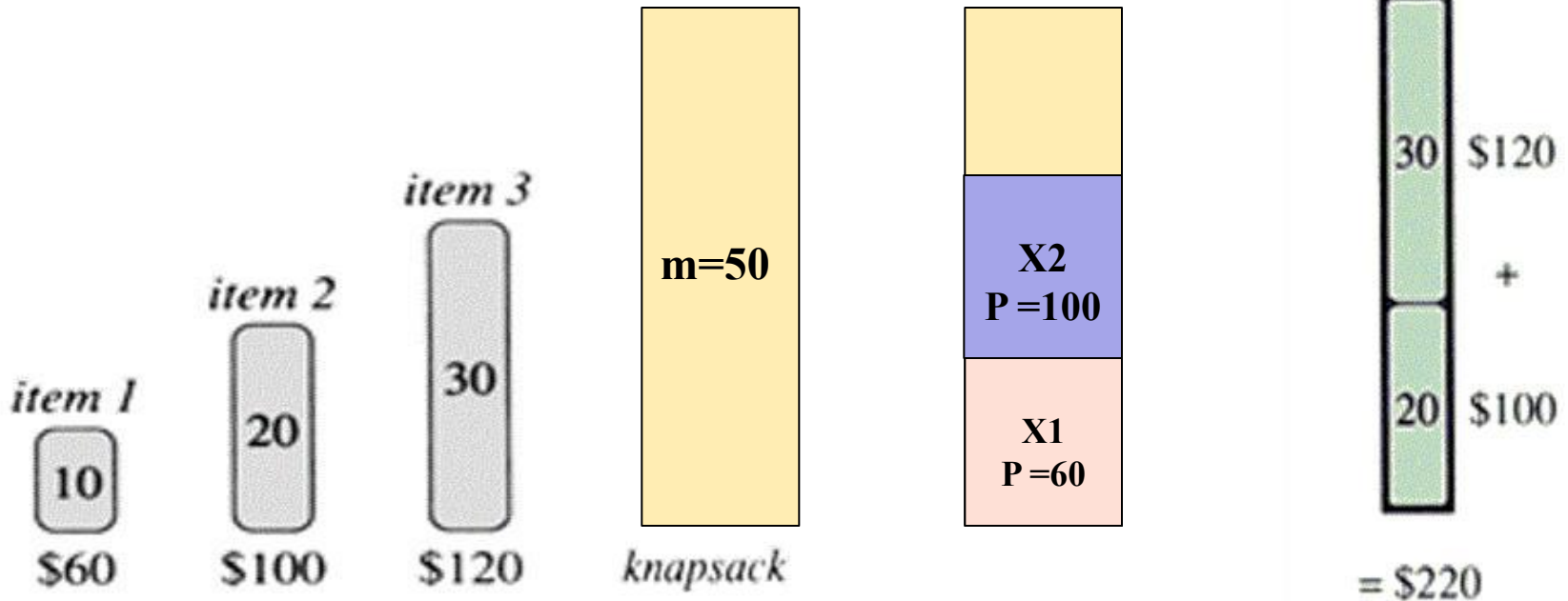
3. Maximum P_i/W_i

X1	X2	X3	$\Sigma W_i X_i$	$\Sigma P_i X_i$
1	2/15	0	20	28.2
0	10/15	1	20	31
0	1	1/2	20	31.5

0/1 Knapsack Problem



0/1 Knapsack



$$\begin{aligned}x_1 &= p_1/w_1 \\ &= 60/10 \\ &= 6\end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}x_2 &= p_2/w_2 \\ &= 100/20 \\ &= 5\end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}x_3 &= p_3/w_3 \\ &= 120/30 \\ &= 4\end{aligned}$$

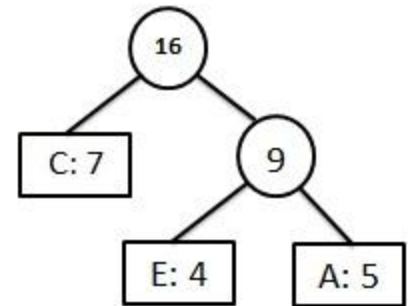
$$\begin{aligned}\text{Profit} &= 60 + 100 \\ &= 160\end{aligned}$$

Drawbacks of Greedy Methods

Does not always find the optimal solution for some problems.

Greedy Algorithms

Part - 4 : Huffman Coding



Huffman Codes

- Widely used technique for **data compression**
- Assume the data to be a sequence of characters
- Looking for an **effective way of storing the data**
- *Binary character code*
- Uniquely represents a character by a **binary string**

Two Ways to Compress data

1. Fixed-Length Codewords

2. Variable-Length Codewords

Example

Suppose you have to compress a data file containing **100,000** characters

The data file only has **6** characters (**a, b, c, d, e, f**)

Characters	a	b	c	d	e	f
Frequency (thousands)	45	13	12	16	9	5

1. Fixed-Length Codes

Data file containing **100,000** characters

Characters	a	b	c	d	e	f
Frequency (thousands)	45	13	12	16	9	5

- 3 bits needed
- $a = 000, b = 001, c = 010, d = 011, e = 100, f = 101$
- Requires: $100,000 * 3 = 300,000$ bits

2. Huffman Codes

- Idea:
 - **Variable Length** Codes
 - Use the frequencies of occurrence of characters to build a optimal way of representing each character

Constructing a Huffman Code

- Idea:

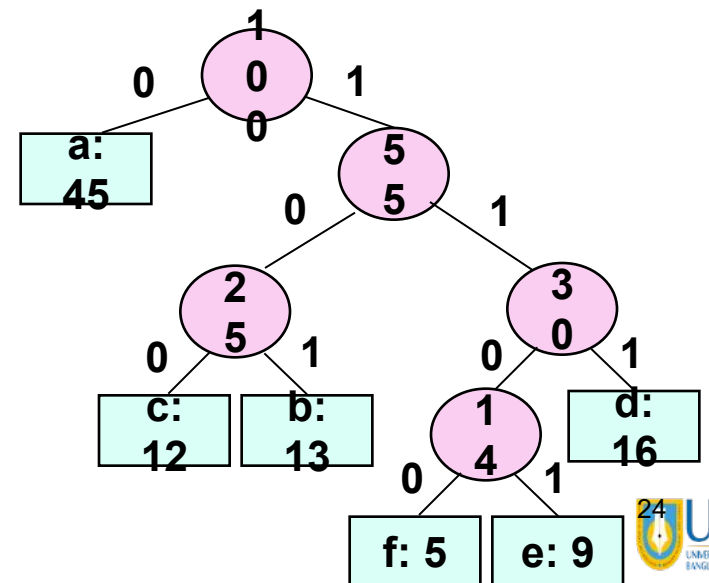
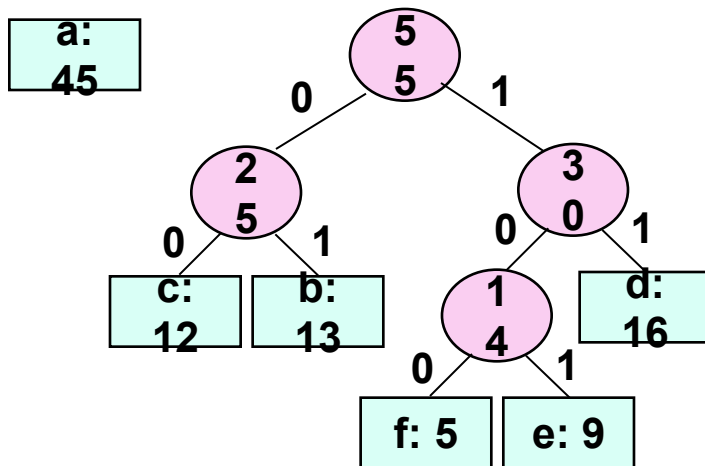
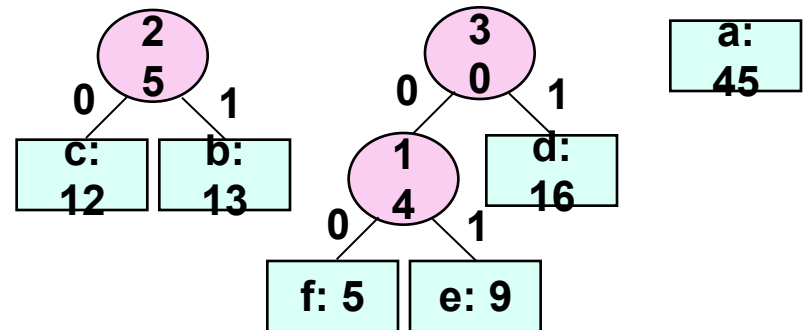
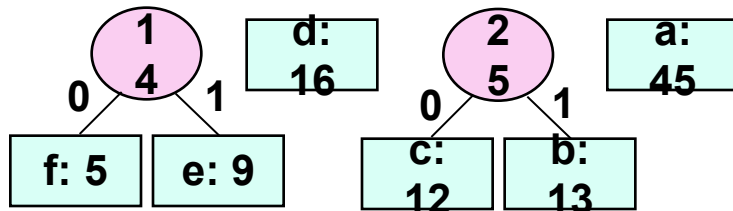
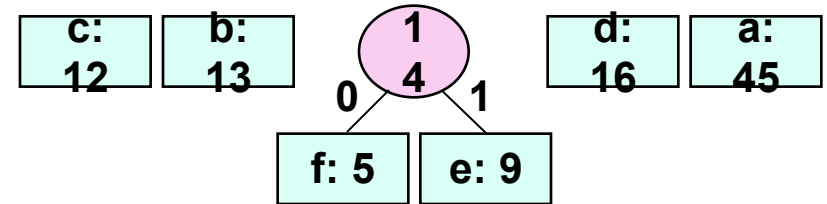
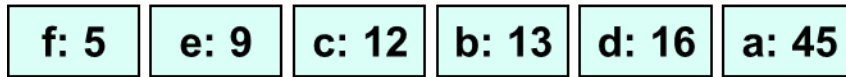
1. Arranging the characters in order of their frequencies

Ascending

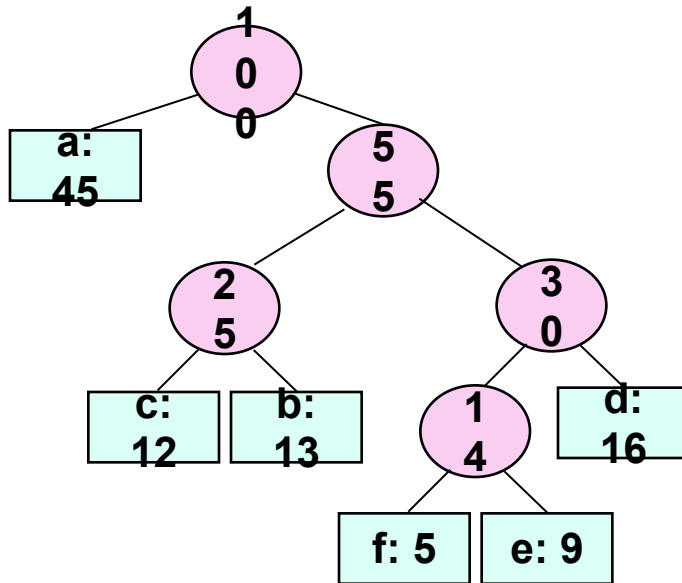
f: 5	e: 9	c: 12	b: 13	d: 16	a: 45
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2. Add Two minimum frequencies and place them to the right position

Example

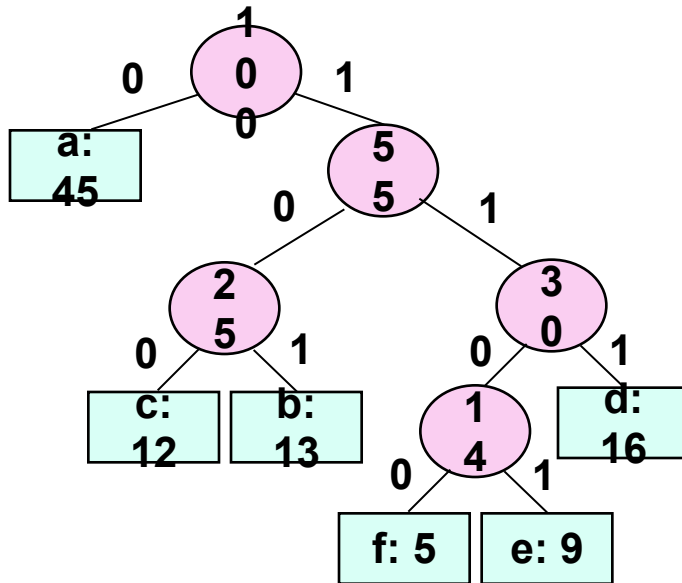


Codewords



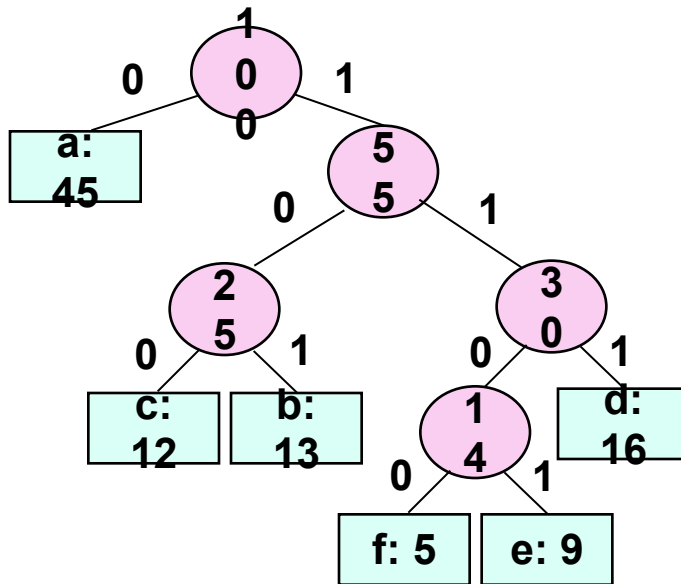
Character	Codeword
a	
b	
c	
d	
e	
f	

Codewords



Character	Codeword
a	
b	
c	
d	
e	
f	

Codewords



Character	Codeword
a	0
b	101
c	100
d	111
e	1101
f	1100

Variable-Length Codes

Data file containing 100,000 characters

Characters	a	b	c	d	e	f
Frequency (thousands)	45	13	12	16	9	5
Variable length Codewords	0	101	100	111	1101	1100

- $((45 * 1) + (13 * 3) + (12 * 3) + (16 * 3) + (9 * 4) + (5 * 4)) * 1,000$
 $= 224,000 \text{ bits}$
- Assign **short codewords** to **frequent characters** and **long codewords** to **infrequent characters**

Comparison Ratio

Characters	a	b	c	d	e	f
Frequency (thousands)	45	13	12	16	9	5
Fixed Length Codewords	000	001	010	011	100	101
Variable length Codewords	0	101	100	111	1101	1100

$$\left[\frac{300000 - 224000}{300000} \right] \times 100 = 25.33\%$$

Saves 20% to 90% cost.

Huffman Code: Algorithm

Alg.: HUFFMAN(C)

Running time: $O(n \lg n)$

1. $n \leftarrow |C|$

2. $Q \leftarrow C$

← $O(n)$

3. **for** $i \leftarrow 1$ **to** $n - 1$

4. **do** allocate a new node z

5. $\text{left}[z] \leftarrow x \leftarrow \text{EXTRACT-MIN}(Q)$

6. $\text{right}[z] \leftarrow y \leftarrow \text{EXTRACT-MIN}(Q)$

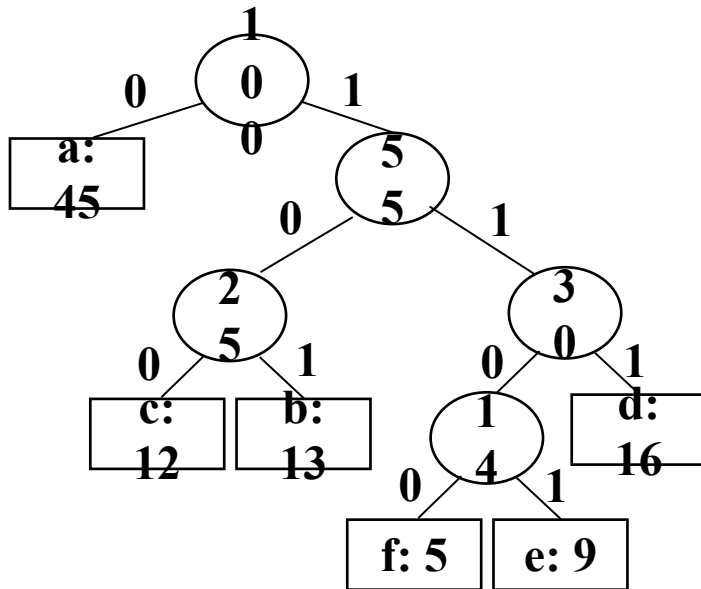
7. $f[z] \leftarrow f[x] + f[y]$

8. $\text{INSERT}(Q, z)$

9. **return** $\text{EXTRACT-MIN}(Q)$

} $O(n \lg n)$

Encoding and Decoding



Character	Codeword
a	0
b	101
c	100
d	111
e	1101
f	1100

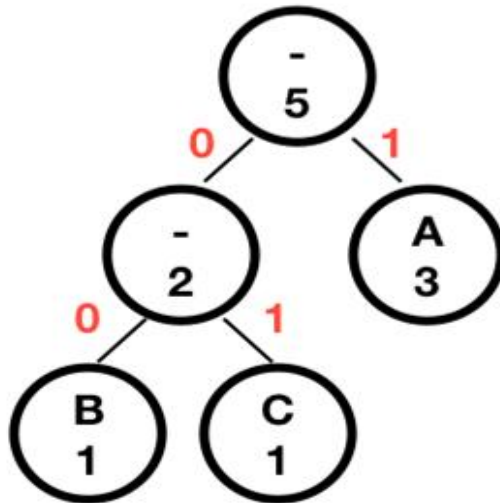
Exercise:

1. Encode : abcde

2. Decode: 101100011111011100

String to be encoded: **ABACA**

A = 3 , B = 1, C = 1



Prefix Codes

A - 1
B - 00
C - 01

Reference

- <http://coursera.org/learn/algorithms-part1/>
- GeeksForGeeks
- YouTube
- LLMs
- Old Lectures of ULAB (Pramanik Sir)



Thank You

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